

they were spending and where their money was going. It finally clicked for him to see how much further their money would go without high income taxes, commuting costs, and daycare expenses.

My wife and I were in a similar situation. She grew up in a household that struggled with money. We got out of debt within a year of starting our careers, and from that point forward we lived a life of abundance. We did whatever we wanted with plenty left over every month to save. When I introduced my wife to the concept of FI by sharing ideas I learned from ERE and MMM, she envisioned a return to a lifestyle of scarcity. But as I demonstrated how little our favorite activities like skiing, hiking, and rock climbing cost and how we could have far more time for these activities without the need to work, she became interested. After our daughter was born, my wife became more acutely aware of how important it was to regain control of our time, and she went all in with me in the pursuit of FI.

Many couples will have similar conversations. Selling the idea of FI to a spouse or partner by presenting one or two articles from a random blogger with an “extreme” lifestyle doesn’t usually work. More often, your partner will think you’ve lost your mind when you say you want them to embrace a lifestyle that on the surface may sound extreme. But if you can present FI as a realistic goal, you can